Airtribe

Problem Discovery, Market and User Research

Week-3

BASIC GUIDELINES

- Keep yourself on mute if you are not speaking
- Keep your cameras on!
- Engage on chat and feel free to speak your mind

Let’s set expectations!

1. Ask questions
2. Practice!

Session Guidelines

- Be honest in questions and feedback. Feedback is anonymous and the aggregate data helps both you and me become better.
- Ask questions. If they look like a blocker, I'll pick it up. Else, we'll discuss it in the end.
- Don't worry if you don't understand a term, I will post the slides. Focus on the message.
- Have fun!! That's most important.

Product Management Roadmap

PHASE 1
CRAFT
Modules 1–4

1. Fundamentals of Product Management
2. Product Strategy & Strategic Thinking
3. Problem Discovery, Market & User Research — WEEK 3
4. Problem Framing & Prioritization

PHASE 2
CRAFT + AI
Modules 5–8

5. UX & Design Collaboration
6. Effective Communication as a PM
7. Analytics & Metrics
8. Product Launch, Growth & Monetization

PHASE 3
DEEP AI
Modules 9–13

9. Tech 101 & System Design
10. LLMs, RAGs & AI Foundations
11. Vibe Coding for PMs
12. Agentic AI & AI Systems in Production
13. Capstone Project & Interview Prep

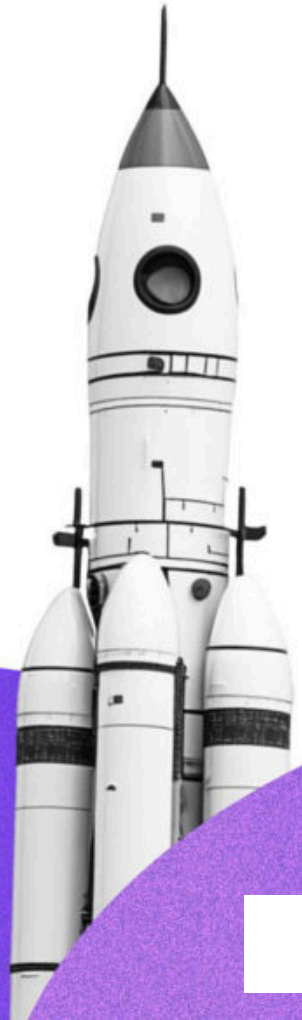
Part 1:

Problem Discovery & Market Research..

1. What is Problem Discovery & Why It Matters
2. Understanding the Key Components of Market Research
3. Validating Ideas Using Market Data and Insights
4. Applying Frameworks Like TAM-SAM-SOM, Porter's Five Forces, and Customer Discovery
5. Evaluating Competitive Landscapes with Confidence
6. Breakout Room Activity
7. Q&A

How many of you have built features that didn't get used?

"value is in what gets used, not what gets built" – Kris Gale.



Problem Discovery

What is Problem Discovery?

Problem Discovery is the process of identifying, understanding, and validating the real problems your users face — before you build anything.

Why It's Called "Discovery"

You're not creating problems. You're **uncovering** them.

Problem discovery – Why it matters ??

Reason	Why it matters
🎯 Ensures you solve the *right* problem	Reduces wasted effort
💸 Prevents product failures	Aligns with real user need
🧠 Builds user empathy	Makes PMs better decision-makers
🧭 Fuels innovation	Opens up non-obvious solutions
📊 Helps with prioritization	Clear inputs for roadmap decisions

From Discovering Problems → Understanding the Market

You've uncovered what frustrates users.

You've listened to their pain, observed their behavior, and collected insights.

But here's the next critical step:

Are these problems worth solving — at scale?

Live Exercise: Enterprise Discovery

Use one B2B product and map who matters in the buying and usage journey.

Notion

1

Pick the product

Why do teams adopt it?



2

List stakeholders

Who buys, who uses, who approves?



3

Map goals

What does each stakeholder want?



4

Find tensions

Where do needs conflict?



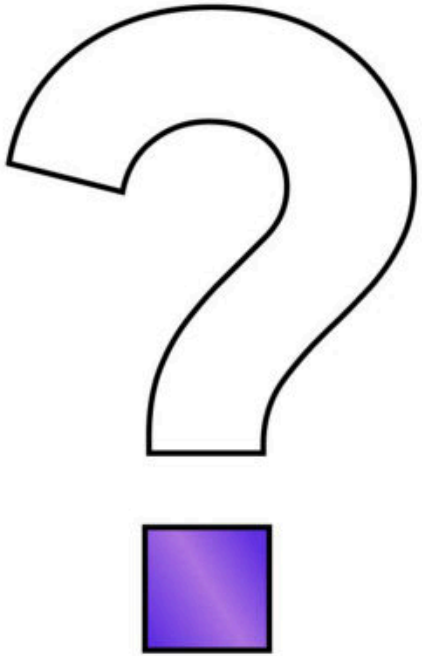
5

Recommend

What should the PM learn or prioritize?



Let’s break for questions



What is Market Research ?

Market Research = Understanding the Opportunity Around the Problem

Market research helps you assess whether a problem is worth solving at scale.

It gives a **strategic view** of the space you're operating in:

- ***Demand:*** What is desire of the product or service?
- ***Market Size:*** How big is the opportunity, size of the market?
- ***Industry Trends:*** What are Industry trends are shaping the space? How many are willing to avail/buy this?
- ***Economic Trends:*** Customer buying capacity? Inflation? Disposable Income?
- ***Market Saturation:*** Are there underserved users? Is this market growing? Opportunity for new entrant?
- ***Pricing:*** Who else is solving this? What price are customer paying for the alternative?
- ***Location:*** High demand geography? Cultural preferences? Operational feasibility?

Case Study :- Zomato

https://drive.google.com/file/d/1MRKgwQQ9t5WvZgOcWgkJqLz6NKeDje0R/view?usp=sharing



Primary Research

First-hand insights directly from your users.

What it is:

You collect new data yourself — directly from market.

Why PMs use it:

- ***Understand real pain points***
- ***Validate user needs***
- ***Test early product concepts***

Examples:

🗣️ 1:1 user interviews
📝 Surveys with open-ended questions
👀 Usability tests on prototypes
📓 Diary studies or field observations

Secondary Research

Leverage existing data to understand the market landscape.

What it is:

You analyze information that already exists — collected by someone else.

Why PMs use it:

- ***Benchmark against competitors***
- ***Spot industry trends***
- ***Understand market size***

Examples:

📊 Industry reports (McKinsey, Statista)
📚 Research papers
🌐 Reddit, Quora, Product Hunt threads
📱 App Store reviews

Pro Tip: Combine Both for Better Insight

Eg:* *Building a new Fintech app for college students

Primary: Interview 10 students about money habits

Secondary: Research RBI trends on digital payments in Gen Z

Real impact comes when you combine direct user signals with market-level intelligence.

Market Sizing

Estimating the potential of a market using **TAM – SAM – SOM** framework:

Terms	*Stands for*	*Description*
TAM	Total Addressable Market	Total demand for the product if everyone used it
SAM	Serviceable Available Market	Portion of TAM you can serve
SOM	Serviceable Obtainable Market	Realistically achievable market share

Market Sizing

Imagine you are opening a pizza restaurant in Bengaluru - HSR.

TAM – The Entire Market

All possible customers who could buy pizza In India - The pizza market is worth **$1 billion** annually.

SAM– Your Reachable Market

Portion of TAM that you can realistically serve based on geography and business model
Your restaurant is in Bengaluru-HSR, so your market is **$10 million.**

SOM – Your Target Customer

Realistic market share you can capture based on competition, pricing, and capacity
10% of HSR's pizza market - **$1 million** a year.

Porter's Five Forces

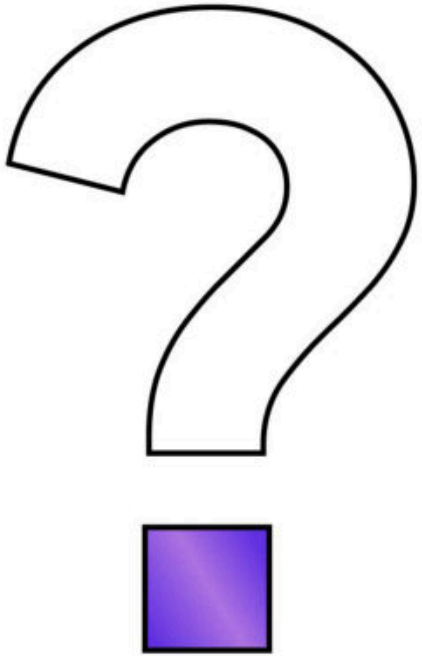






Force	IRCTC	Urban Company
Threat of New Entrants	Low	Moderate to High
Supplier Power	Low	High
Buyer Power	Low	High
Threat of Substitutes	Moderate	High
Industry Rivalry	Low	High

Let’s break for questions



Competitive Analysis

What

Identifying, evaluating, and benchmarking competitors to understand their strengths, weaknesses, market positioning, and potential threats.

Why

- Identify Market Gap
- Prepare for competitive threats
- Build Solid GTM Strategy

How

- Identify Direct/Indirect and Substitute Competitors
- Gather Data for from demos/ press release / Financial report / Customer feedback / word of mouth / Analyst reports - Gartner
- Benchmark performance, swot, key features, pricing

Competitive Analysis- Case Study

Trans.io is an AI startup that provides both real-time and batch transcription services, enabling businesses to convert audio and video content into text with high accuracy and low latency.

As a Product Manager for Trans.io perform competitive analysis to build the product strategy and roadmap.



Competitive

Trans.io

Airtribe

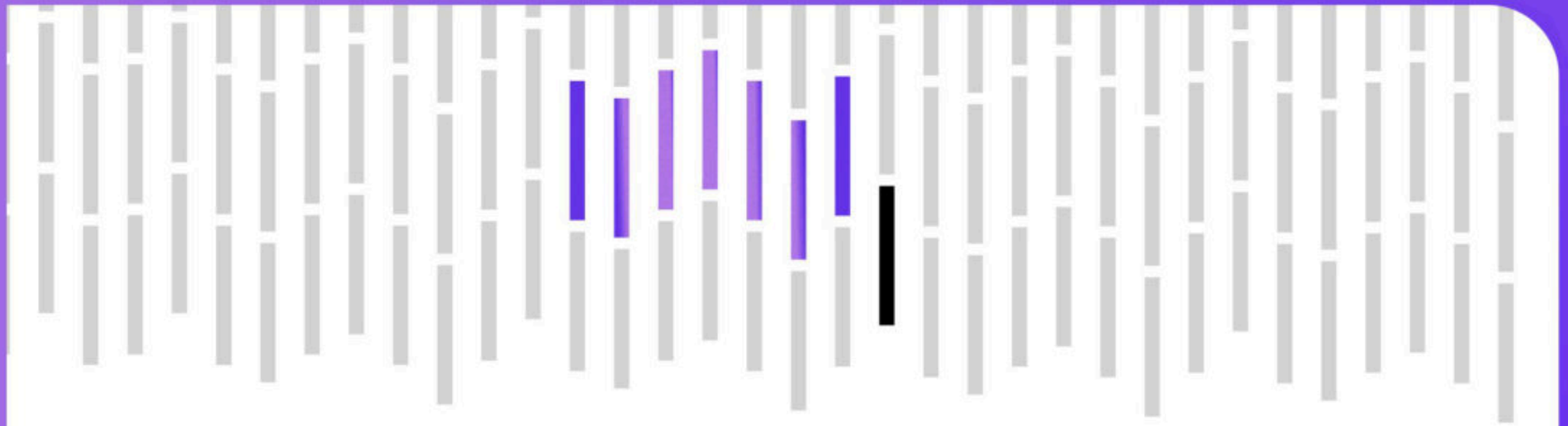
Features & Capabilities (Winner– Speed, Price, Error)	Deepgram 1,1,4	Speechmatics 4,3,2	Google 3,2,3	Amazon Transcribe 2,4,1
Infracture & Language support	AWS Support 30+	AWS Support 50	Google Only 125	Native Aws solutions 100
Performance	WER (Word Error Rate) – 18.4 Batch File size – unlimited # transcription session @ once –> 10 Diarization – Up to 10	WER (Word Error Rate) – 11.3 Batch File size – 2 hours # transcription session @ once = 100 sessions Diarization – Up to 10	WER (Word Error Rate) – 17.7 Batch File size – async 6 hours Diarization – Up to 6	WER (Word Error Rate) – 10.9 Batch File size – 4 hours # transcription session @ once = 100 sessions Diarization – Up to 10
Features	Noise Reduction ✅ Deep Search (Audio) ✅ Redaction ✅ Punctuation ✅ Profanity Filter ✅ Numeral Formatting ✅ Custom Vocabulary ✅	Noise Reduction ✅ Deep Search (Audio) ❌ Redaction ✅ Punctuation ✅ Profanity Filter ✅ Numeral Formatting ✅ Custom Vocabulary ✅	Noise Reduction ✅ Deep Search (Audio) ❌ Redaction ✅ Punctuation ✅ Profanity Filter ✅ Numeral Formatting ✅ Custom Vocabulary ✅	Noise Reduction ✅ Deep Search (Audio) ❌ Redaction ✅ Punctuation ✅ Profanity Filter ✅ Numeral Formatting ✅ Custom Vocabulary ✅
Pricing	$0.25/hr	$1.3/hr	$0.96/hr	$1.44/hr
Customer Reviews/ Downtime	257 reviews Downtime	19 reviews Downtime	241 reviews Downtime	Down

Live Class Activity

Should Uber enter the **2-wheeler EV ride-hailing** segment in India? If yes, why? If no, why not?

Support your decision with data and build Market Analysis & Competition Landscape





It’s Time for Breakout Room

Q & A

Part 2:

User Research..

1. What is a User research ? 🤔
2. Why it is needed ?
3. User research approaches 🤨
4. Define Customer Segments & Personas
5. Turn user research into strategy Pitch ☀
6. Breakout room activity 😍
7. Q&A 🤝

Learning Outcome

Learn what, why and how of user research

Live Group Activity

A group activity to turn user research into strategy Pitch

The what, why and how of user research

What is User Research?

➔ Set of approaches to **deeply understand** your product users from **their own perspective** (and not via data points or assumed “personas”)

- What do people **really need** wrt your problem space and in **what priority** order
- If you aren’t a direct user, help you **put yourself in their shoes** – literally

➔ Approaches change based on which stage the product is at :

- Build a **new product** from scratch
- Figure **what to solve** in current product
- Figure **how to solve** a particular problem in an existing product
- **Get confidence** on a proposed solution hypothesis
- Or just to figure why are your **metrics going haywire**... more.

Why is it needed?

- ➔ **Product metrics** only answer **the "what"** — not the "why" or "why not"
- ➔ **Product strategy** is driven the leadership's "personal" assumptions based on what they've seen or heard — not what's the true problem statement.



By leveraging user research, you get...

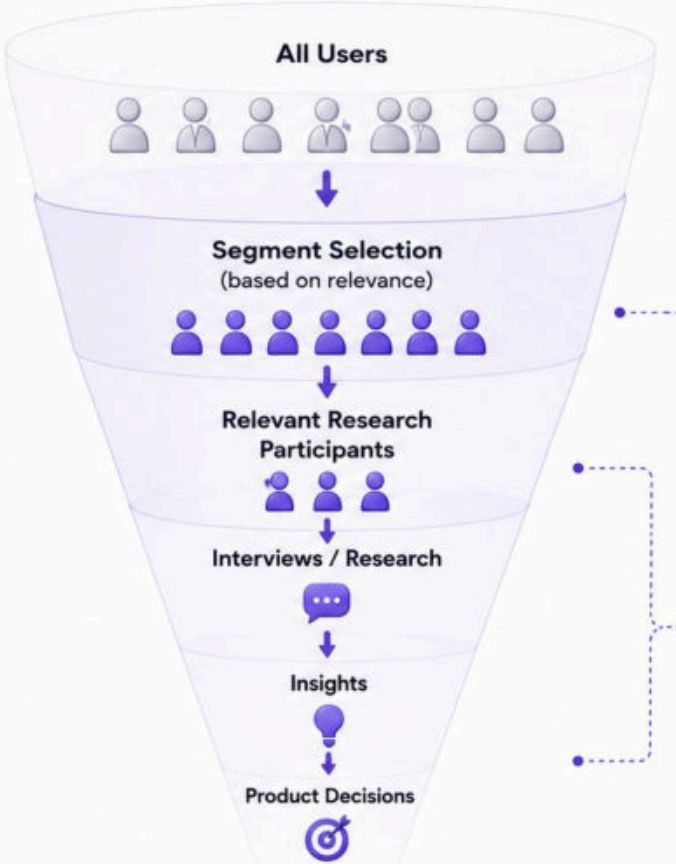
- ➔ **"True confidence"** in what you're building **before you build it**
- ➔ OR **"True reasons"** for why people are doing what they're doing — expected or not
- ➔ **Remember** : Everyone carries a "**bias to build**" – how well you control & route will single-handedly decide how great of a product professional you will be.

Who Exactly Are We Researching?

Good research starts with clarity about who can help us answer the problem we are trying to solve.

RESEARCH GOAL (EXAMPLE)

Understand why new users abandon onboarding in the first 3 days.



WRONG

Interviewing random users leads to noisy, misleading insights.

BETTER

Interviewing the right users answers the right questions.

B2B Discovery Is Different

In B2B products, the user is often not the only person who matters.

B2C Discovery



- single user or household
- focus on usage, needs, and behavior
- purchase and usage are often closely linked

B2B Discovery



- multiple stakeholders influence the decision
- economic buyer, end user, admin, and evaluator may differ
- workflow and hierarchy matter
- adoption depends on both product value and organizational fit

A PM must map not just the user journey, but also the decision journey.

Buying Committee: Notion Enterprise Example

Notion Enterprise

One workspace tool. Different stakeholders. Different concerns.



1. Economic Buyer

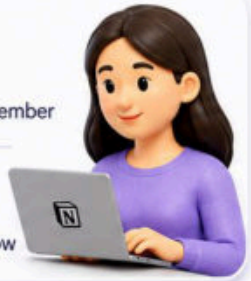
Example: VP Operations / CFO

Cares about:
ROI, team productivity, cost, seat pricing

2. End User

Example: PM, Designer, Engineer, Marketing team member

Cares about:
Ease of use, speed, documentation, daily workflow



One product. Many decision makers.



3. Technical Evaluator

Example: IT / Security team

Cares about:
SSO, permissions, data security, integrations

4. Champion

Example: Team Lead / Product Ops Manager

Cares about:
Solving team chaos, getting buy-in, driving adoption



? Discovery questions should change depending on who you are speaking to.

Notion brings teams, docs, and projects together in one connected workspace.

Stakeholder Dynamics in B2B Products

A strong PM understands where incentives align — and where they conflict.



End User

ease and speed

Manager

team productivity







IT / Security

compliance and control

Finance / Procurement

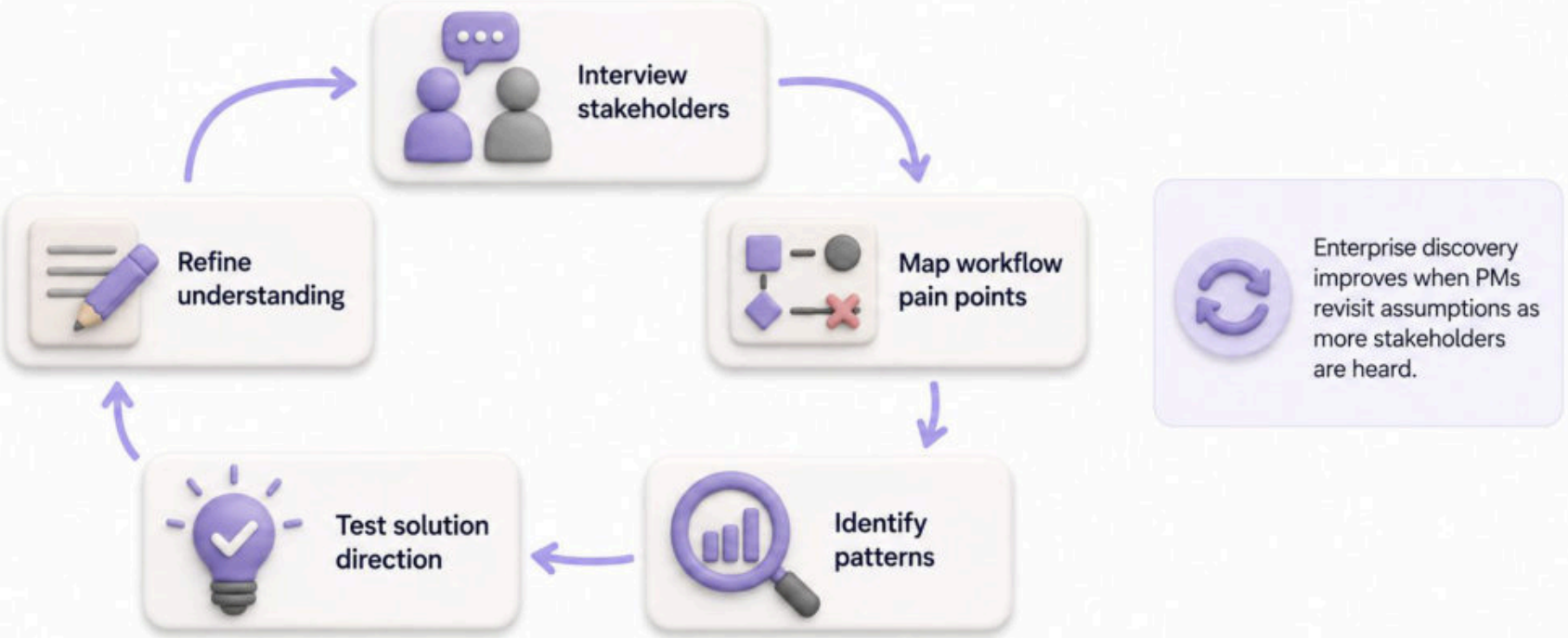
cost and approval



The same product can feel valuable to one stakeholder and risky to another.

Continuous Feedback in B2B Discovery

Discovery is not one interview — it is an ongoing loop across stakeholders and workflows.



Types of User Research

PMs use different methods for different questions.



Interviews

Deep conversations to understand thoughts and motivations



Surveys

Collect feedback at scale to identify patterns and trends



Observation

Watch users in their natural context to see real behavior



Analytics

Use product data to find behavioral insights and opportunities

Use multiple methods to get a complete and unbiased understanding.

Surveys 1/5

- ➔ Used to get a “**general pulse**” from the user’s end
- ➔ Quickly help decide which direction to **dive more into or ignore**
- ➔ Need enough responses (by volume) to find **reliable patterns**
- ➔ Doesn’t have to be only close-ended questions – people happily respond to **open-ended queries** (“What did you like the most?” // “Any other comments?”)

  - ◆ These responses especially help in getting unexpected, deep insights

Surveys 1/5

Advanced insights

- ➔ Fill rate starts to go down drastically **after 5 questions.**
- ➔ Don't use results from surveys **as-is** to make **strategic calls** – always augment with a **deeper** research method.
- ➔ For more **contextual**, **reliable** & **higher response rate** try to target the user when they're actually on your product (instead of sending the link to their email or SMS inbox)
    - Blitzlamma is one such modern tools that allows this.

Blitzllama

Kraftful

Passive user observation 2/5

- ➔ Observing how people actually use a product **in their natural setting** – your product or a **competing/lateral product**

- ➔ Understand users in an **unbiased** fashion –
  - Helps generate deeper questions to ask
  - New insights to leverage for product design
  - Figure which product flows can be killed or trimmed
  - ....more!



Passive user observation 2/5

➔ **Step 1** : Look at "**user flow chart**" to identify **interesting parts** of product to observe :

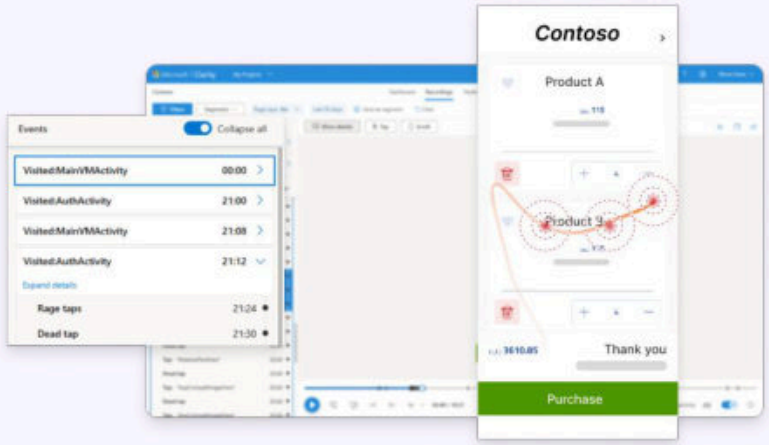
- Is there a particular flow that 90% users keep using **frequently**?
- Is there a step where users are spending **too much time** and/or are dropping off?
- Where do users head to, right after launching the product?



This is a standard visualisation in product analytics tools like Mixpanel & Amplitude.

Passive user observation 2/5

- **Step 2** : Use screen recording/analytics to **“see” what people are actually doing across these flows**
  - Screen recording tools like (free) Clarity from microsoft, (paid) UXcam for mobile apps, (paid) Smartlook for web products



hotjar

Active user observation 3/5

➔ **Live, guided version** of product usage observation

➔ Get people to use a product – **your product or competitor or a design prototype** – while both of you're able to talk to each other.

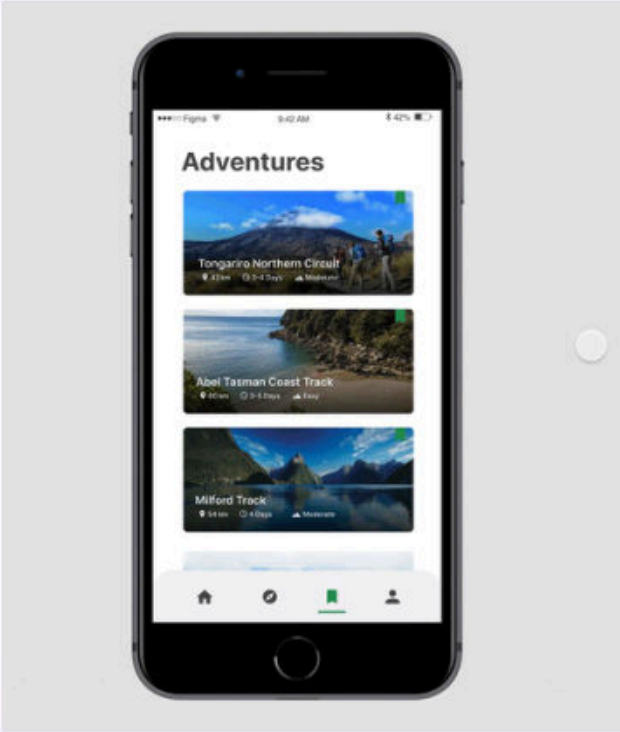


➔ Key **benefits** :

- You can "listen" to what's going in their mind
- You can ask clarifying questions
- You can nudge them in the right direction (based on your goal)

➔ **Using design prototype (most popular!)**

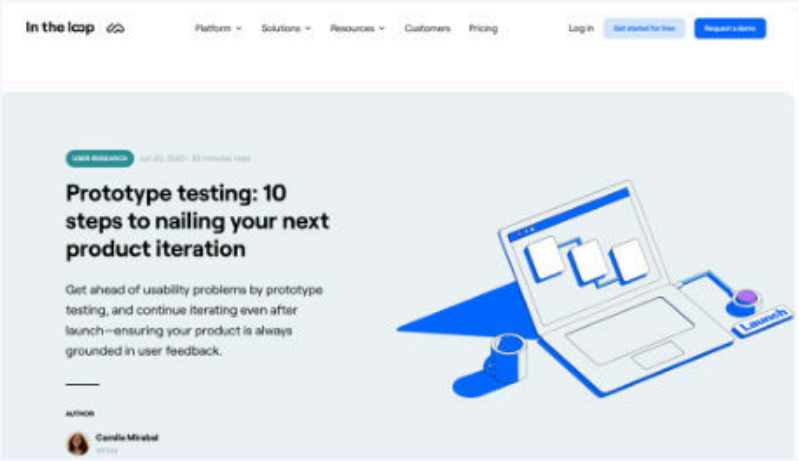
Very useful to test **understandability** (are people able to figure what this is? are they excited to use it?) and **usability** (are people able to use it on their own? are they delighted while using it?)



Tips :

- Be ready with 2-3 tasks that you want them to complete – don’t define steps, define goals (how would you book a view using this?)

- People won’t be able to understand that it’s a prototype (and not a real product) so make the **information & interactions** on the screens is as realistic as possible.



lovable

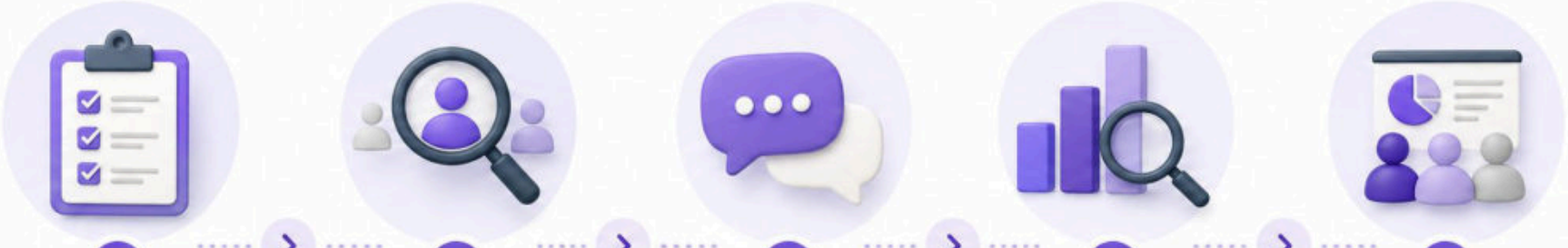
1:n conversation 4/5

- **Moderated research** where questions are asked about user's perceptions, beliefs, opinion or ideas – across user segments.
- **Free flow** discussion (Participants are encouraged to talk openly) – Focus group discussion.
- Optimum group size : 8 to 12 users
- Users need to be **recruited** and pre-screened



How PMs Conduct User Interviews

Good interviews are about empathy, curiosity, and listening.



1

Prepare

Define objective, questions, and user criteria

2

Recruit

Find the right participants for your research

3

Conduct

Have a natural conversation. Listen more.

4

Synthesize

Find patterns, key takeaways, and quotes

5

Share

Share learnings with the team and act on them

In depth interviews (IDP) 5/5

- ➔ **One-on-one interview** with the participant.
- ➔ Duration: 30 to 60 minutes.
- ➔ **Guiding Research Questionnaire** is used, but flexible to ask follow up questions based on participant's answers.
- ➔ Start with general questions and then move to **more specific ones**.
- ➔ Ask **ice-breaker questions** to make the participant feel comfortable.



CASE STUDY - ZEPTO

zepto

Problem Statement

You joined Zepto as a Product Manager and are **asked to solve the following issue.**

Users often forget to reorder essential grocery items they need regularly, such as milk, bread, fruits, vegetables, and household supplies.

Because of this, they place multiple small orders, spend extra time reordering, and may pay additional delivery charges.

Design a subscription model for Zepto that helps users remember, manage, and reorder recurring essentials in one go.





THE PROBLEM

Forget recurring essentials

Miss replenishment cycles

Place multiple small orders

Repetitive and time-consuming

Higher delivery costs

THE SOLUTION

A subscription model that helps users manage and reorder essentials

CASE STUDY – ZEPTO

Case Study – Zepto

Define Target People to Interview:

Students



Housewife



Mothers



User Types:

- Users who order groceries online at least once or twice a month.
- Users with more than four family members.

Research Criteria

- **Product/problem you are researching:** Grocery product
- **Age groups we want to identify:** 18+
- **Gender ratio:** 50:50
- **Occupation:** Students, housewife, mothers



zepto

Case Study – Zepto

Let's understand user habits
through a structured conversation.



Warm-up questions:

1. What is your name and age?
2. How many members are there in your family?
3. How often do you order groceries online per month?
4. Where do you buy your groceries regularly?

Understanding interaction, behaviour and decision-making:

1. How do you plan to buy groceries?
2. What problems do you face when ordering groceries?
3. Do you get everything you need? If not, what do you do then?
4. When you place an order, do you order the same items as your previous order?
5. How do you decide when to place an order online?
6. Which is your favourite grocery store and why?

These questions help us uncover **real user needs, pain points and decision drivers.**

CASE STUDY – ZEPTO

Understanding How the User Takes Action While Ordering

zepto



The Grocery Ordering Journey

1 → 2 → 3 → 4 → 5

1. REORDER HABITS

1. What do you do when you have to reorder anything?
2. What steps do you take when something ends up in stock?
9. What items do you reorder daily?
5. Would you like to maintain your base/ regular order every month?
6. What do you think of the monthly order that can be repeated?

2. FRESHNESS & TRUST

3. Do you order fruits and vegetables online?
   a. If yes, what convinces you that you can get fresh fruits and vegetables?
   b. If not, is there a reason behind it?
4. On what basis are you ordering an item?

3. BASKET BUILDING

8. Do you make a shopping list before you buy groceries?
10. Do you buy all your groceries in one place?
12. What things do you buy the most?
14. Are there any items you like to buy in bulk?

4. PAYMENT & CHECKOUT

7. When do you pay for the order? When do you put it on, or when does it arrive?
11. Which payment method do you prefer?

5. SAFETY & SPEND

15. What safety precautions do you take when shopping?
17. How much money do you spend on it? (Processed food/ fresh food/ cleaners/ bathroom/ cleaning products)

CASE STUDY – ZEPTO

zepto

Top Insights from User Research

User 1: *Reluctant Replenisher*



- Buys when stock is low (reactive ordering).
- Recently switched to online but prefers in-store experience.
- Lacks awareness of other online vendors.

Insights:

- **Behavioral Insight:** Needs nudges/reminders when stock is low.
- **Motivational Insight:** Comfort with known vendors; hesitant to explore.
- **Pain Point:** Fear of trying unknown platforms due to lack of knowledge.

User 2: *The Scheduled Selector*



- Orders in strict routines — weekly or monthly.
- Prefers organized grocery experiences at larger stores.
- Avoids unstructured or local vendors.



Insights:

- **Behavioral Insight:** Runs shopping like clockwork.
- **Preference Insight:** Looks for clean UI and structured product categories.
- **Pain Point:** Overwhelmed or disinterested in less organized sources.

What Is Customer Segmentation?

Segmentation helps PMs group users in a way that makes research and product decisions more precise.

Customer segmentation is the process of **grouping users by meaningful similarities** such as their characteristics, behavior, context, or needs. It helps PMs focus research on the right users, understand what matters to them, and make better product decisions.



Demographic

age, income, occupation, life stage.

- **Examples:** students, working professionals, parents.

Geographic

location, region, city tier, climate.

- **Examples:** metro users, Tier 2 or 3 city users.

Behavioral

usage patterns, frequency, loyalty, habits.

- **Examples:** frequent users, occasional users.

Need-based

jobs to be done, goals, constraints.

- **Examples:** save time, save money, stay healthy.

Customer Segmentation at Zomato

The same product serves different user needs.

Students

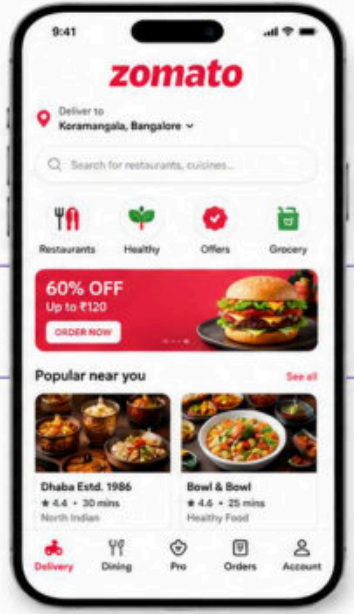
Needs: Affordable meals, discounts

What we can learn:
Price sensitivity, value perception

Families

Needs: Safe & hygienic food, variety for all

What we can learn:
Trust factors, family preferences



Food delivery app example

Working Professionals

Needs: Fast delivery, reliable tracking

What we can learn:
Time constraints, convenience drivers

Fitness Enthusiasts

Needs: Healthy options, nutrition info

What we can learn:
Health goals, information needs

From Segmentation to Targeting

Zomato example — PMs identify user groups, then choose one segment to focus on first.

1. Students
price sensitive, high frequency

2. Working Professionals
time sensitive, repeat orders

3. Families
group ordering, reliability

4. Fitness-focused users
healthy options, routine needs

Chosen Target: Working Professionals

- High urgency during workdays
- Repeat ordering behavior
- Strong need for reliable delivery
- Good long-term retention potential



Targeting means choosing the segment where the pain is strongest and the behavior is repeatable.

PMs don't build for every segment at once.
They choose where to focus first.

Evaluating segments based on what matters

Segment	Pain intensity (How strong is the need?)	Market size (How many are there?)	Willingness to pay (Will they pay for value?)	Ease of reaching (Can we reach them well?)	Strategic fit (Does it align with Zomato?)
Students	Medium	High	Low	High	Medium
Working Professionals	High	High	Medium	High	High
Families	Medium	Medium	Medium	Medium	Medium
Fitness-Focused Users	High	Medium	Medium	Medium	Low

We will start by solving for Working Professionals.
Once we win here, we can expand to other segments.



Our Target Segment

Working Professionals

Busy people who order food because they value convenience, speed and reliability during workdays.

Why this segment for Zomato?

- **High urgency:** Need quick meals between meetings / long work hours
- **Frequent behavior:** Order multiple times a week
- **Strong need for reliability:** Trust Zomato for quality & on-time delivery
- **High LTV potential:** Repeat orders across meals, days and occasions
- **Aligned with Zomato's mission:** "Better food for more people" in their everyday lives

Zomato's advantage with this segment

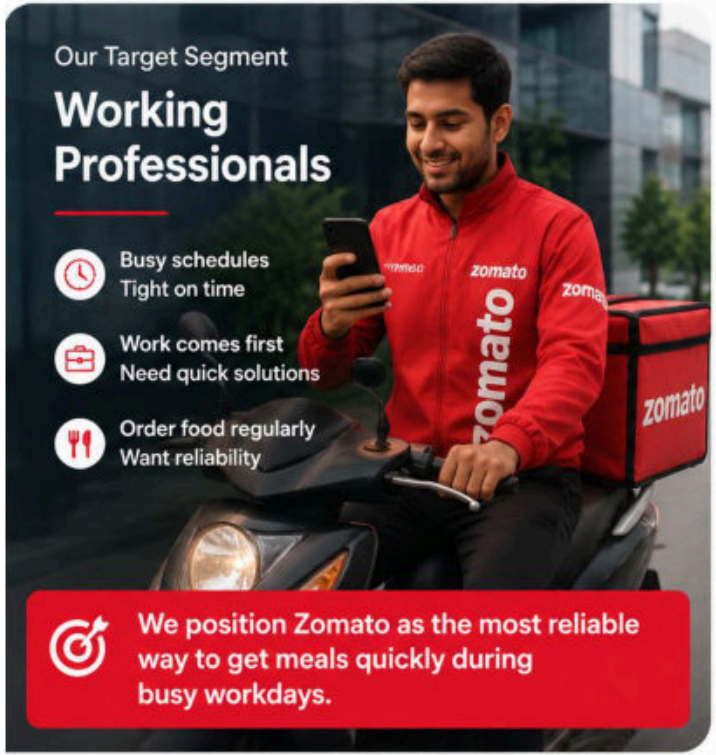
Fast Delivery | Wide Restaurant Choice | Great Offers | Reliable

STEP 3 OF 3

zomato

Positioning for the Chosen Segment

Once we choose our target, we decide how Zomato will be seen in their minds.



Our Positioning Statement

Zomato is the reliable way for working professionals to get good food, fast.

What this means for them

Saves Time	Reliable	Good Food	Hassle-Free
Quick delivery for busy workdays.	On-time delivery they can count on.	Wide choice and consistent quality.	Easy ordering, tracking and support.

How this guides our decisions

Build for speed and convenience	Ensure restaurant quality & variety	Improve tracking & reliability	Make support quick & helpful

What Makes a Good Persona?

Personas are useful only when they capture goals, behavior, and context.

Weak Persona

- 28-year-old female
- Lives in Bengaluru
- Marketing professional
- Likes online shopping

Why it is weak: only demographics, no goals, behavior, pain points, or context.

Stronger Persona



Name: Ananya, 28, Marketing Manager, Bengaluru.

Goals: Wants to eat healthy but has very little time due to work.

Behaviors: Orders food 3–4 times a week, checks reviews and ingredients.

Pain Points: Hard to find healthy options that taste good and arrive fast.

Motivations: Wants to stay fit, save time, and eat clean.

What is not User Persona?



PRINCE CHARLES

- Male
- Born in 1948
- Raised in the UK
- Married twice
- Lives in a castle
- Wealthy & famous



OZZY OSBOURNE

- Male
- Born in 1948
- Raised in the UK
- Married twice
- Lives in a castle
- Wealthy & famous

Source: Warwick Allchorn (Linkedin)

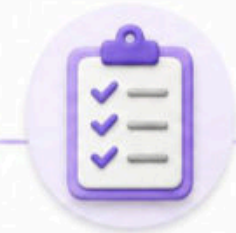
From Segments to Personas

Personas make segments actionable by adding behavior, motivation, and context.



Segment

Understand the group.



Behaviors

Identify what they do.



Motivations

Understand why they do it.



Constraints

Note time, money, knowledge, or workflow limits.



Persona

Create a human-centered representation.

Example User Persona

User Persona for Pay via UPI at Fuel Stations Product







Segment	Tech Savvy (App Users)	Tech Savvy (Non-App Users)	Non Tech Savvy
Demographic	• Age: 18 - 50 • Gender : Male, • Occupation : Students, Professional • Geography: Urban -Tier I, Tier II	• Age: 35-55 • Gender : Female • Occupation: Professional, Homemaker, Business • Geography: Urban -Tier I, Tier II	• Age: 18 - 65 • Gender: Male • Occupation : Truck Driver, Agriculture • Geography: Urban - Tier III, Rural
Physiographic	• Modern • Innovators • Early adopter • Experimenter	• Mature • Convenience seeker • High on value • Late adopter	• Orthodox • Value for Money
Behavioral	• Usage: Frequent Smart Phone users • Explore New Apps • Influencer: Peers, Friends • Uses more tech gadgets	• Usage: Less Frequent Smart Phone users • Prefer using websites than apps • Influencer: Peers, Friends	• Usage: No Smart Phone users • Less knowledge of technology • Influencer: Friends, Relatives
Barriers to adopt App based Payment Solution	• Security • Trust issues • Incentives to use App over Cards	• Complex UI in Apps • More inclination to use of desktop than mobile • Security & Trust Issues • Incentive to use App based solution	• No exposure to Smartphones and Internet • Long acquired habit of using cash • High hindrance to adopt to technology

Take-home Assignment

Uber

Uber is one of the most widely used mobility platforms, helping millions of users get from point A to point B quickly and reliably.

However, for many users—especially in dense urban areas—the experience after booking a ride can still feel uncertain and stressful. Once a ride is confirmed, users often struggle with questions like: ***Where exactly should I stand? Will the driver find me easily? Should I move to a better pickup point?***

In crowded locations such as malls, office complexes, airports, or busy streets, drivers may find it difficult to reach the exact pinned location. This often leads to multiple calls, cancellations, or delays.

While Uber shows a pickup point and ETA, it does not always proactively guide users toward the most optimal or realistic pickup experience in complex environments. Uber is exploring whether it can play a more active role in helping users coordinate pickups more effectively, reduce confusion, and improve overall reliability of the pickup experience.

As a **Product Manager**, your task is to evaluate this opportunity and outline how you would approach understanding the problem before proposing solutions.

Take-home Assignment

Uber

Your Task:

Step 1: Conduct Market Research and Comp Analysis around this proposition

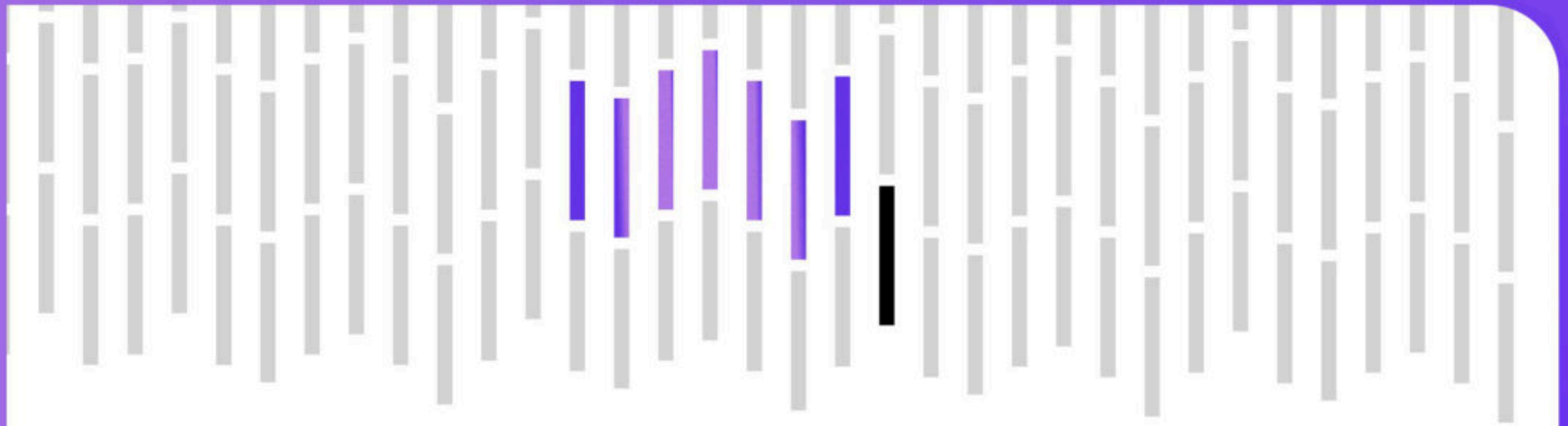
- Analyze demand across user segments
- Identify and size the target market
- Study existing alternatives users rely on today
- Assess restrictions, rules and other laws
- Assess market trends

Step 2: Conduct In-Depth User Interviews (use Surveymonkey, Lovable)

- **Talk to at least 10 person**
- Capture qualitative insights—ask open-ended questions to **understand user behavior, preferences, and frustrations.**
- **Record proof of interviews:**
  - **Videos or pictures** of interviewees (with their consent).
  - **Screenshots of messages** if interviews are conducted online.

Step 3: Summarise your insights & Define Segment, Target and Persona for the selected segment.

[Week 3 : Session 2 (take home assignment) Template]



It’s Time for Breakout Room

User profiles:

Fintech – Budgeting App

“I’ve tried using budgeting apps before, but they feel like a chore. I just want something that works quietly in the background and nudges me when I’m overspending.”
— 32 y/o marketing professional, lives in a metro city

“I check my bank app almost every day, but I still don’t really know where my money goes each month.”
— 28 y/o software engineer, single, lives in a tier-1 city

“I know I should save more, but life’s unpredictable. Sometimes I just need flexibility without guilt.”
— 35 y/o freelance graphic designer, parent of one, lives in a suburban area

“I want to feel in control of my money without spending hours each week analyzing charts.”
— 25 y/o content creator, lives in a shared flat, spends irregularly

“I share finances with my partner, and we always struggle with transparency and splitting shared expenses.”
— 34 y/o project manager, cohabiting, lives in an urban area

Fintech – Budgeting App

"I don't earn a lot, so every rupee matters. I just want a simple way to avoid end-of-month surprises."
— 29 y/o call center executive, rents a small apartment, lives in a tier-2 city

"I've got multiple credit cards and EMIs, and sometimes I forget what's due when. I need something that helps me stay ahead without stressing me out."
— 38 y/o sales professional, married with two kids, lives in a metro city

"I'm trying to build wealth, but most financial tools feel made for people who already have money."
— 27 y/o early-stage startup employee, investing beginner, lives in a co-living space

"My parents depend on me financially. I need to manage not just my money, but theirs too."
— 31 y/o government employee, single, primary breadwinner, lives in a joint family in a small town

"I love tracking every transaction—it gives me peace of mind. But I wish I didn't have to switch between five different apps to do it."
— 30 y/o chartered accountant, meticulous planner, lives in a metro city

"I travel a lot for work, so my spending patterns are erratic. I need something smart enough to adapt to that."
— 33 y/o management consultant, frequent traveler, lives in serviced apartment

Thank

you!

